

Σ

A Library for ANSI Common Lisp

<https://github.com/cgore/sigma/>

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INCOMPLETE DRAFT

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Contents

Copyright	ix
Introduction	xi
1 The sigma/behave Package	1
1.1 Macros	1
1.1.1 The behavior Macro	1
1.1.2 The spec Macro	2
1.1.3 The should Macro	3
1.1.4 The should-not Macro	3
1.1.5 The should-be-null Macro	4
1.1.6 The should-be-true Macro	4
1.1.7 The should-be-false Macro	4
1.1.8 The should-be-a Macro	5
1.1.9 The should= Macro	5
1.1.10The should-not= Macro	6
1.1.11The should/= Macro	6
1.1.12The should-not/= Macro	6
1.1.13The should< Macro	7
1.1.14The should-not< Macro	7
1.1.15The should> Macro	8
1.1.16The should-not> Macro	8
1.1.17The should<= Macro	9
1.1.18The should-not<= Macro	9
1.1.19The should>= Macro	9
1.1.20The should-not>= Macro	10
1.1.21The should-eq Macro	10
1.1.22The should-not-eq Macro	11
1.1.23The should-eql Macro	11
1.1.24The should-not-eql Macro	12
1.1.25The should-equal Macro	12
1.1.26The should-not-equal Macro	12
1.1.27The should-equalp Macro	13
1.1.28The should-not-equalp Macro	13

1.1.29	The should-string= Macro	14
1.1.30	The should-not-string= Macro	14
1.1.31	The should-string/= Macro	15
1.1.32	The should-not-string/= Macro	15
1.1.33	The should-string< Macro	15
1.1.34	The should-not-string< Macro	16
1.1.35	The should-string> Macro	16
1.1.36	The should-not-string> Macro	17
1.1.37	The should-string<= Macro	17
1.1.38	The should-not-string<= Macro	18
1.1.39	The should-string>= Macro	18
1.1.40	The should-not-string>= Macro	18
1.1.41	The should-string-equal Macro	19
1.1.42	The should-not-string-equal Macro	19
1.1.43	The should-string-not-equal Macro	20
1.1.44	The should-not-string-not-equal Macro	20
1.1.45	The should-string-lessp Macro	21
1.1.46	The should-not-string-lessp Macro	21
1.1.47	The should-string-greaterp Macro	21
1.1.48	The should-not-string-greaterp Macro	22
1.1.49	The should-string-not-greaterp Macro	22
1.1.50	The should-not-string-not-greaterp Macro	23
1.1.51	The should-string-not-lessp Macro	23
1.1.52	The should-not-string-not-lessp Macro	24
2	The sigma/control Package	25
2.1	Macros	25
2.1.1	The aif Macro	25
2.1.2	The a?if Macro	26
2.1.3	The aand Macro	27
2.1.4	The a?and Macro	27
2.1.5	The alambda Macro	28
2.1.6	The a?lambda Macro	28
2.1.7	The ablock Macro	28
2.1.8	The a?block Macro	28
2.1.9	The acond Macro	29
2.1.10	The a?cond Macro	29
2.1.11	The awhen Macro	29
2.1.12	The a?when Macro	30
2.1.13	The awhile Macro	30
2.1.14	The a?while Macro	31
2.1.15	The deletef Macro	31
2.1.16	The do-while Macro	31
2.1.17	The do-until Macro	32
2.1.18	The fop Macro	32
2.1.19	The for Macro	32

2.1.20	The forever Macro	33
2.1.21	The multicond Macro	33
2.1.22	The opf Macro	33
2.1.23	The swap Macro	34
2.1.24	The swap-unless Macro	34
2.1.25	The swap-when Macro	34
2.1.26	The until Macro	35
2.1.27	The while Macro	35
2.2	Functions	36
2.2.1	The compose Function	36
2.2.2	The conjoin Function	36
2.2.3	The curry Function	37
2.2.4	The disjoin Function	37
2.2.5	The function-alias Function	37
2.2.6	The operator-to-function Function	38
2.2.7	The rcompose Function	38
2.2.8	The rcurry Function	39
2.2.9	The unimplemented Function	39
2.3	Generics	39
2.3.1	The duplicate Generic	39
3	The sigma/hash Package	41
3.1	Macros	41
3.1.1	The sethash Macro	41
3.1.2	The set-partition Macro	41
3.2	Functions	42
3.2.1	The populate-hash-table Function	42
3.2.2	The inchash Function	42
3.2.3	The dechash Function	42
3.2.4	The gethash-in Function	42
3.2.5	The make-partition Function	43
3.2.6	The populate-partition Function	43
4	The sigma/numeric Package	45
4.1	Macros	45
4.1.1	The +f Macro	45
4.1.2	The -f Macro	45
4.1.3	The *f Macro	45
4.1.4	The /f Macro	45
4.1.5	The divf Macro	45
4.1.6	The f+ Macro	46
4.1.7	The f- Macro	46
4.1.8	The f* Macro	46
4.1.9	The f/ Macro	47
4.1.10	The multf Macro	47
4.2	Functions	48

4.2.1	The bit? Function	48
4.2.2	The choose Function	48
4.2.3	The factorial Function	48
4.2.4	The fractional-part Function	48
4.2.5	The fractional-value Function	48
4.2.6	The integer-range Function	48
4.2.7	The nonnegative? Function	48
4.2.8	The nonnegative-integer? Function	48
4.2.9	The positive-integer? Function	48
4.2.10	The product Function	48
4.2.11	The sum Function	49
4.2.12	The unsigned-integer? Function	49
4.3	Types	49
4.3.1	The nonnegative-float Type	49
4.3.2	The nonnegative-integer Type	49
4.3.3	The positive-float Type	49
4.3.4	The positive-integer Type	49
5	The sigma/os Package	51
5.1	Functions	51
5.1.1	The perl Function	51
5.1.2	The python Function	51
5.1.3	The read-file Function	51
5.1.4	The read-lines Function	51
5.1.5	The ruby Function	51
5.2	Parameters	51
5.2.1	The *perl-path* Parameter	51
5.2.2	The *python-path* Parameter	52
5.2.3	The *ruby-path* Parameter	52
6	The sigma/probability Package	53
6.1	Macros	53
6.1.1	The decaying-probability? Macro	53
6.2	Functions	53
6.2.1	The probability? Function	53
6.3	Types	53
6.3.1	The probability Type	53
7	The sigma/random Package	55
7.1	Macros	55
7.1.1	The nshuffle Macro	55
7.2	Functions	55
7.2.1	The gauss Function	55
7.2.2	The random-argument Function	55
7.2.3	The coin-toss Function	55
7.2.4	The random-in-range Function	55

7.2.5	The random-in-ranges Function	55
7.2.6	The random-range Function	56
7.2.7	The randomize-array Function	56
7.2.8	The random-array Function	56
7.3	Generics	56
7.3.1	The random-element Generic	56
7.3.2	The shuffle Generic	56
8	The sigma/sequence Package	57
8.1	Macros	57
8.1.1	The arefable? Macro	57
8.1.2	The nconcf Macro	57
8.1.3	The nthable? Macro	57
8.1.4	The set-nthcdr Macro	57
8.2	Functions	57
8.2.1	The array-values Function	57
8.2.2	The nth-from-end Function	57
8.2.3	The sequence? Function	58
8.2.4	The empty-sequence? Function	58
8.2.5	The join-symbol-to-all-following Function	58
8.2.6	The join-symbol-to-all-preceeding Function	58
8.2.7	The list-to-vector Function	59
8.2.8	The max* Function	59
8.2.9	The min* Function	59
8.2.10	The set-equal Function	60
8.2.11	The simple-vector-to-list Function	60
8.2.12	The sort-order Function	60
8.2.13	The the-last Function	60
8.2.14	The vector-to-list Function	60
8.3	Generics	60
8.3.1	The best Generic	60
8.3.2	The minimum Generic	60
8.3.3	The minimum? Generic	60
8.3.4	The maximum Generic	60
8.3.5	The maximum? Generic	60
8.3.6	The sort-on Generic	60
8.3.7	The slice Generic	61
8.3.8	The split Generic	61
8.3.9	The worst Generic	61
9	The sigma/string Package	63
9.1	Functions	63
9.1.1	The character-range Function	63
9.1.2	The character-ranges Function	64
9.1.3	The escape-tildes Function	64
9.1.4	The replace-char Function	64

9.1.5 The <code>strcat</code> Function	64
9.1.6 The <code>strmult</code> Function	64
9.1.7 The <code>string-join</code> Function	64
9.1.8 The <code>stringify</code> Function	64
9.1.9 The <code>to-string</code> Function	65
9.2 Methods	65
9.2.1 The <code>split</code> Methods	65
10 The time-series Package	67
10.1 Macros	67
10.1.1 The <code>snap-index</code> Macro	67
10.2 Functions	67
10.2.1 The <code>array-raster-line</code> Function	67
10.2.2 The <code>distance</code> Function	67
10.2.3 The <code>norm</code> Function	67
10.2.4 The <code>raster-line</code> Function	67
10.2.5 The <code>similar-points?</code> Function	67
10.2.6 The <code>time-series?</code> Function	68
10.2.7 The <code>time-multiseries?</code> Function	68
10.2.8 The <code>tmsref</code> Function	68
10.2.9 The <code>tms-dimensions</code> Function	68
10.2.10 The <code>tms-raster-line</code> Function	68
10.2.11 The <code>tms-values</code> Function	68
10.3 Types	68
10.3.1 The <code>time-multiseries</code> Type	68
11 The truth Package	69
11.1 Functions	69
11.1.1 The <code>[?]</code> Function	69
11.1.2 The <code>toggle</code> Function	69
11.2 Generics	69
11.2.1 The <code>? Generic</code>	69
12 The sigma Package	71
12.1 Variables	71
12.1.1 The <code>*sigma-packages*</code> Variable	71
12.2 Functions	71
12.2.1 The <code>use-all-sigma</code> Function	71

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Introduction

The Σ library is a generic library of mostly random useful code for ANSI Common Lisp. It is currently only really focused on SBCL, but patches to add support for other systems are more than welcome.

This library started out as a single file, `utilities.lisp`, that I personally used for shared generic code for all of my Lisp code. Most lispers have a similar file of some name, `utilities.lisp`, `misc.lisp`, `shared.lisp`, or even `stuff.lisp`, that is just a random collection of useful little generic macros and functions. Mine has grown over the years, and in 2012 I decided that I should try to make it useful to people other than myself.

You can download the library from GitHub at:

<https://github.com/cgore/sigma>

and I have some other information on it at my own website at:

<http://cgore.com/programming/lisp/sigma/>

Getting Lisp

Before using this library you need a working Lisp. I use and recommend SBCL, Steel Bank Common Lisp, which is available at:

<http://www.sbcl.org>

This is derived from CMUCL, Carnegie Mellon University Common Lisp, which is still under active development and is: available at:

<http://www.cons.org/cmucl/>

SBCL has information on getting started at:

<http://www.sbcl.org/getting.html>

If you are using Debian or a similar Linux distribution (including Ubuntu), you can just run as root:

```
apt-get install sbcl sbcl-doc sbcl-source
```

Getting EMACS and SLIME

After installing, the best way to interact with any Common Lisp is via SLIME, the Superior Lisp Interaction Mode for EMACS, which is avail-

able at:

`http://common-lisp.net/project/slime/`

This can be installed on Debian by:

```
apt-get install slime emacs emacs-goodies-el
```

Using the Library

First we need to clone the utilities.

```
mkdir -p /programming/lisp
cd /programming/lisp
git clone git@github.com:cgore/sigma.git
```

Now we need to make a directory for our project and symlink to the ASDF definition. There are other ways to load ASDF libraries, especially if you want to have them available globally; I strongly recommend you read the documentation to ASDF.

```
mkdir our-new-project
cd our-new-project
ln -s /programming/lisp/sigma/sigma.asd
```

Now we need to start up our Lisp REPL. The best way to do this for personal use is SLIME from within Emacs, but I will demonstrate using the shell itself here.

```
sbcl
```

Now we are in SBCL. Let's calculate something.

$$\sum_{i=0}^{100} i$$

```
(require :asdf)} ; Require ASDF
(require :sigma) ; Require the Sigma system via ASDF.
(sigma:use-all-sigma) ; This will pollute COMMON-LISP-USER.
(sum (loop for i from 1 to 100
      collect i)) ; Returns 5050, and makes Euler sad.
```

Have fun!

Chapter 1

The `sigma/behave` Package

The `sigma/behave` package contains some useful code for confirming behavior of code, supporting a very basic form of *behavior-driven development*, BDD. The basic flow is to define the *behavior* of something, with multiple *specs* specified within that behavior specification, each consisting of various assertions, such as `should=`, `should-equal`, `should-not-equal`, and many others. If the behavior of the thing doesn't match the specified behavior, then there is some error.

1.1 Macros

1.1.1 The behavior Macro

The `behavior` macro is used to specify a block of expected behavior for a `thing`. It specifies an example group, loosely similar to the `describe` blocks in Ruby's `RSpec`. It takes a single argument, the `thing` we are trying to describe, and then a body of code to evaluate that is evaluated in an implicit `progn`. It is to be used around a set of examples, or around a set of assertions directly.

Syntax

```
(behavior thing &body body)
```

Arguments and Values

thing This is what we are describing the behavior of.

body This is an implicit `proc` to contain the behavior.

Examples

```
(behavior 'float
  (spec "is_an_Abelian_group"
    (let ((a (random 10.0))
          (b (random 10.0))
          (c (random 10.0))
          (e 1.0))
      (spec "closure"
        (should-be-a 'float (* a b)))
      (spec "associativity"
        (should= (* (* a b) c)
                  (* a (* b c))))
      (spec "identity_element"
        (should= a (* e a)))
      (spec "inverse_element"
        (let ((1/a (/ 1 a)))
          (should= (* 1/a a)
                    (* a 1/a)
                    1.0)))
      (spec "commutativity"
        (should= (* a b) (* b a))))))
```

1.1.2 The spec Macro

The `spec` macro is used to indicate a specification for a desired behavior. It will normally serve as a grouping for assertions or nested specs.

Syntax

```
(spec description &body body)
```

Arguments and Values

description This is a string to describe the specification.

body This is an implicit proc to contain the specification.

Examples

```
(spec "should_pass_some_tests"
  (should= 12 (foo 3.5))
  (should= 14 (foo 4.22)))
```

1.1.3 The `should` Macro

The `should` macro is the basic building block for most of the behavior checking. It asserts that `test` returns truthfully for the arguments. Typically you will want to use one of the macros defined on top of `should` instead of using it directly, such as `should=`.

Syntax

```
(should test &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

test This is the test predicate to evaluate.

arguments These are the arguments to the test predicate.

Examples

```
(should #'= 12 (* 3 4)) ; Passes  
(should #'< 4 (* 2 3)) ; Passes  
(should #'< 4 5 6 7)    ; Passes
```

1.1.4 The `should-not` Macro

The `should-not` macro is identical to the `should` macro, except that it inverts the result of the call with `not`.

Syntax

```
(should-not test &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

test This is the test predicate to evaluate.

arguments These are the arguments to the test predicate.

Examples

```
(should-not #'< 12 4) ; Passes  
(should-not #'= 12 44) ; Passes
```

1.1.5 The should-be-null Macro

The `should-be-null` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'null ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-be-null &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `null`.

Examples

```
(should-be-null ()) ; Passes  
(should-be-null nil) ; Passes  
(should-be-null (not 12)) ; Passes  
(should-be-null (and t t nil)) ; Passes
```

1.1.6 The should-be-true Macro

The `should-be-true` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'identity ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-be-true &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `identity`.

Examples

```
(should-be-true t) ; Passes  
(should-be-true (not nil)) ; Passes  
(should-be-true (or nil nil 12)) ; Passes
```

1.1.7 The should-be-false Macro

The `should-be-false` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'not ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-be-false &rest arguments)
```


Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `not`.

Examples

```
(should-be-false nil)
(should-be-false (not t))
(should-be-false (< 44 2))
```

1.1.8 The should-be-a Macro

The `should-be-a` macro specifies that one or more things should be of the type specified by `type`.

Syntax

```
(should-be-a type &rest things)
```

Arguments and Values

type This is the type to compare with via `typep`.

things These are the things to confirm the type of.

```
(should-be-a 'integer 1)           ; Passes
(should-be-a 'float 1)            ; Passes
(should-be-a 'integer 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9) ; Passes
(should-be-a 'integer 1.0)        ; Fails
```

1.1.9 The should= Macro

The `should=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `=`.

Examples

```
(should= 12 12) ; Passes
(should= 12 12.0) ; Passes
```

1.1.10 The `should-not=` Macro

The `should-not=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `=`.

Examples

```
(should-not= 12 12)    ; Fails  
(should-not= 12 12.0) ; Fails  
(should-not= 12 14)    ; Passes
```

1.1.11 The `should/=` Macro

The `should/=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'/= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should/= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `/=`.

Examples

```
(should/= 12 13)    ; Passes  
(should/= 12 12)    ; Fails  
(should/= 12 12.0) ; Fails
```

1.1.12 The `should-not/=` Macro

The `should-not/=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'/= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not/= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `/=`.

Examples

```
(should-not/= 12 13)    ; Fails  
(should-not/= 12 12)    ; Passes  
(should-not/= 12 12.0) ; Passes
```

1.1.13 The `should<` Macro

The `should<` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'< ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should< &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `<`.

Examples

```
(should< 12 13) ; Passes  
(should< 13 12) ; Fails  
(should< 12 12) ; Fails
```

1.1.14 The `should-not<` Macro

The `should-not<` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'< ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not< &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `<`.

Examples

```
(should-not< 12 13) ; Passes
(should-not< 13 12) ; Fails
(should-not< 12 12) ; Fails
```

1.1.15 The should> Macro

The `should<` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'> ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should> &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `>`.

Examples

```
(should> 12 13) ; Fails
(should> 13 12) ; Passes
(should> 12 12) ; Fails
```

1.1.16 The should-not> Macro

The `should-not>` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'> ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not> &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `>`.

Examples

```
(should-not> 12 13) ; Passes
(should-not> 13 12) ; Fails
(should-not> 12 12) ; Passes
```

1.1.17 The `should<=` Macro

The `should<=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'<= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should<= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `<=`.

Examples

```
(should<= 12 13) ; Passes  
(should<= 13 12) ; Fails  
(should<= 12 12) ; Passes
```

1.1.18 The `should-not<=` Macro

The `should-not<=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'<= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not<= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `<=`.

Examples

```
(should-not<= 12 13) ; Fails  
(should-not<= 13 12) ; Passes  
(should-not<= 12 12) ; Fails
```

1.1.19 The `should>=` Macro

The `should>=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'>= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should>= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `>=`.

Examples

```
(should>= 12 13) ; Fails  
(should>= 13 12) ; Passes  
(should>= 12 12) ; Passes
```

1.1.20 The should-not>= Macro

The `should-not>=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'>= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not>= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `>=`.

Examples

```
(should-not>= 12 13) ; Passes  
(should-not>= 13 12) ; Fails  
(should-not>= 12 12) ; Fails
```

1.1.21 The should-eq Macro

The `should-eq` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'eq ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-eq &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `eq`.

Examples

```
(should-eq 12 12)           ; Probably passes
(should-eq 13 12)           ; Fails
(should-eq "foo" "foo")     ; May pass, may fail.
```

1.1.22 The should-not-eq Macro

The `should-not-eq` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'eq ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-eq &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `eq`.

Examples

```
(should-not-eq 12 12)       ; Probably fails
(should-not-eq 13 12)       ; Passes
(should-not-eq "foo" "foo") ; May pass, may fail.
```

1.1.23 The should-eql Macro

The `should-eql` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'eql ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-eql &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `eql`.

Examples

```
(should-eql 12 12)          ; Passes
(should-eql 13 12)          ; Fails
(should-eql "foo" "foo")    ; May pass, may fail.
```

1.1.24 The `should-not-eql` Macro

The `should-not-eql` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'eql ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-eql &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `eql`.

Examples

```
(should-not-eql 12 12)           ; Fails  
(should-not-eql 13 12)           ; Passes  
(should-not-eql "foo" "foo")     ; May pass, may fail.
```

1.1.25 The `should-equal` Macro

The `should-equal` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'equal ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-equal &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `equal`.

Examples

```
(should-equal 12 12)             ; Passes  
(should-equal 13 12)             ; Fails  
(should-equal "foo" "foo")       ; Passes  
(should-equal "FOO" "foo")       ; Fails
```

1.1.26 The `should-not-equal` Macro

The `should-not-equal` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'equal ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-equal &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to equal.

Examples

```
(should-not-equal 12 12)           ; Passes  
(should-not-equal 13 12)           ; Fails  
(should-not-equal "foo" "foo")     ; Fails  
(should-not-equal "FOO" "foo")     ; Passes
```

1.1.27 The should-equalp Macro

The `should-equalp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'equalp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-equalp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to equalp.

Examples

```
(should-equalp 12 12)              ; Passes  
(should-equalp 13 12)              ; Fails  
(should-equalp "foo" "foo")        ; Passes  
(should-equalp "FOO" "foo")        ; Passes
```

1.1.28 The should-not-equalp Macro

The `should-not-equalp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'equalp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-equalp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `equalp`.

Examples

```
(should-not-equalp 12 12)      ; Passes  
(should-not-equalp 13 12)      ; Fails  
(should-not-equalp "foo" "foo") ; Passes  
(should-not-equalp "FOO" "foo") ; Fails
```

1.1.29 The `should-string=` Macro

The `should-string=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string=`.

Examples

```
(should-string= "foo" "foo") ; Passes  
(should-string= "FOO" "foo") ; Fails
```

1.1.30 The `should-not-string=` Macro

The `should-not-string=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string=`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string= "foo" "foo") ; Fails  
(should-not-string= "FOO" "foo") ; Passes
```

1.1.31 The should-string/= Macro

The `should-string/=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string/= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string/= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string/=`.

Examples

```
(should-string/= "foo" "foo") ; Fails  
(should-string/= "FOO" "foo") ; Passes
```

1.1.32 The should-not-string/= Macro

The `should-not-string/=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string/= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string/= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string/=`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string/= "foo" "foo") ; Passes  
(should-not-string/= "FOO" "foo") ; Fails
```

1.1.33 The should-string< Macro

The `should-string<` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string< ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string< &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to string<.

Examples

```
(should-string< "foo" "f")           ; Fails  
(should-string< "foo" "foo")        ; Fails  
(should-string< "foo" "FOOBAR")     ; Fails  
(should-string< "foo" "foobar")     ; Passes
```

1.1.34 The should-not-string< Macro

The `should-not-string<` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string< ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string< &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to string<.

Examples

```
(should-not-string< "foo" "f")       ; Passes  
(should-not-string< "foo" "foo")     ; Passes  
(should-not-string< "foo" "foobar") ; Fails
```

1.1.35 The should-string> Macro

The `should-string>` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string> ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string> &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to string>.

Examples

```
(should-string> "foo" "f")           ; Passes  
(should-string> "foo" "foo")        ; Fails  
(should-string> "foo" "FOO")        ; Passes  
(should-string> "foo" "foobar")     ; Fails
```

1.1.36 The should-not-string> Macro

The `should-not-string>` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string> ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string> &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string>`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string> "foo" "f")       ; Fails  
(should-not-string> "foo" "foo")     ; Passes  
(should-not-string> "foo" "foobar") ; Passes
```

1.1.37 The should-string<= Macro

The `should-string<=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string<= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string<= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string<=`.

Examples

```
(should-string<= "foo" "f")          ; Fails  
(should-string<= "foo" "foo")        ; Passes  
(should-string<= "foo" "foobar")    ; Passes
```

1.1.38 The `should-not-string<=` Macro

The `should-not-string<=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string<= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string<= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string<=`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string<= "foo" "f")           ; Passes  
(should-not-string<= "foo" "foo")        ; Fails  
(should-not-string<= "foo" "foobar")     ; Fails
```

1.1.39 The `should-string>=` Macro

The `should-string>=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string>= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string>= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string>=`.

Examples

```
(should-string>= "foo" "f")               ; Passes  
(should-string>= "foo" "foo")             ; Passes  
(should-string>= "foo" "foobar")          ; Fails
```

1.1.40 The `should-not-string>=` Macro

The `should-not-string>=` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string>= ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string>= &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string>=`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string>= "foo" "f")      ; Fails  
(should-not-string>= "foo" "foo")    ; Fails  
(should-not-string>= "foo" "foobar") ; Passes
```

1.1.41 The should-string-equal Macro

The `should-string-equal` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string-equal ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string-equal &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-equal`.

Examples

```
(should-string-equal "foo" "foo")    ; Passes  
(should-string-equal "FOO" "foo")    ; Passes  
(should-string-equal "foo" "foobar") ; Fails
```

1.1.42 The should-not-string-equal Macro

The `should-not-string-equal` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string-equal ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string-equal &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-equal`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string-equal "foo" "foo")      ; Fails  
(should-not-string-equal "FOO" "foo")     ; Fails  
(should-not-string-equal "foo" "foobar") ; Passes
```

1.1.43 The should-string-not-equal Macro

The `should-string-not-equal` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string-not-equal ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string-not-equal &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-not-equal`.

Examples

```
(should-string-not-equal "foo" "foo")      ; Fails  
(should-string-not-equal "FOO" "foo")     ; Fails  
(should-string-not-equal "foo" "foobar") ; Passes
```

1.1.44 The should-not-string-not-equal Macro

The `should-not-string-not-equal` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string-not-equal ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string-not-equal &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-not-equal`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string-not-equal "foo" "foo") ; Passes  
(should-not-string-not-equal "FOO" "foo") ; Passes  
(should-not-string-not-equal "foo" "foobar") ; Fails
```


1.1.45 The `should-string-lessp` Macro

The `should-string-lessp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string-lessp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string-lessp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-lessp`.

Examples

```
(should-string-lessp "foo" "f")           ; Fails  
(should-string-lessp "foo" "foo")        ; Fails  
(should-string-lessp "foo" "FOOBAR")     ; Passes  
(should-string-lessp "foo" "foobar")     ; Passes
```

1.1.46 The `should-not-string-lessp` Macro

The `should-not-string-lessp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string-lessp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string-lessp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-lessp`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string-lessp "foo" "f")       ; Passes  
(should-not-string-lessp "foo" "foo")     ; Passes  
(should-not-string-lessp "foo" "FOOBAR")  ; Fails  
(should-not-string-lessp "foo" "foobar")  ; Fails
```

1.1.47 The `should-string-greaterp` Macro

The `should-string-greaterp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string-greaterp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string-greaterp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to string-greaterp.

Examples

```
(should-string-greaterp "foo" "f")           ; Passes  
(should-string-greaterp "foo" "foo")        ; Fails  
(should-string-greaterp "foo" "FOO")        ; Fails  
(should-string-greaterp "foo" "foobar")     ; Fails
```

1.1.48 The should-not-string-greaterp Macro

The should-not-string-greaterp macro is a short-hand method for (should-not #'string-greaterp ...).

Syntax

```
(should-not-string-greaterp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to string-greaterp.

Examples

```
(should-not-string-greaterp "foo" "f")       ; Fails  
(should-not-string-greaterp "foo" "foo")     ; Passes  
(should-not-string-greaterp "foo" "FOO")     ; Passes  
(should-not-string-greaterp "foo" "foobar")  ; Passes
```

1.1.49 The should-string-not-greaterp Macro

The should-string-not-greaterp macro is a short-hand method for (should #'string-not-greaterp ...).

Syntax

```
(should-string-not-greaterp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-not-greaterp`.

Examples

```
(should-string-not-greaterp "foo" "f")      ; Fails
(should-string-not-greaterp "foo" "foo")    ; Passes
(should-string-not-greaterp "foo" "FOO")    ; Passes
(should-string-not-greaterp "foo" "foobar") ; Passes
```

1.1.50 The `should-not-string-not-greaterp` Macro

The `should-not-string-not-greaterp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string-not-greaterp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string-not-greaterp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-not-greaterp`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string-not-greaterp "foo" "f")      ; Passes
(should-not-string-not-greaterp "foo" "foo")    ; Fails
(should-not-string-not-greaterp "foo" "FOO")    ; Fails
(should-not-string-not-greaterp "foo" "foobar") ; Fails
```

1.1.51 The `should-string-not-lessp` Macro

The `should-string-not-lessp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should #'string-not-lessp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-string-not-lessp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-not-lessp`.

Examples

```
(should-string-not-lessp "foo" "f")           ; Passes  
(should-string-not-lessp "foo" "foo")        ; Passes  
(should-string-not-lessp "foo" "FOOBAR")     ; Fails  
(should-string-not-lessp "foo" "foobar")     ; Fails
```

1.1.52 The should-not-string-not-lessp Macro

The `should-not-string-not-lessp` macro is a short-hand method for `(should-not #'string-not-lessp ...)`.

Syntax

```
(should-not-string-not-lessp &rest arguments)
```

Arguments and Values

arguments These are the arguments to `string-not-lessp`.

Examples

```
(should-not-string-not-lessp "foo" "f")       ; Fails  
(should-not-string-not-lessp "foo" "foo")     ; Fails  
(should-not-string-not-lessp "foo" "FOOBAR")  ; Passes  
(should-not-string-not-lessp "foo" "foobar")  ; Passes
```

Chapter 2

The `sigma/control` Package

The `sigma/control` package contains code for basic program control systems. These are mostly basic macros to add more complicated looping, conditionals, or similar. These are typically extensions to Common Lisp that are inspired by other programming languages. Thanks to the power of Common Lisp and its macro system, we can typically implement most features of any other language with little trouble.

2.1 Macros

2.1.1 The `aif` Macro

The `aif` macro is an anaphoric variation of the built-in `if` control structure. This is based on [1, p. 190]. The basic idea is to provide an anaphor (such as pronouns in English) for the conditional so that it can easily be referred to within the body of the conditional expression. The most natural pronoun in the English language for a thing is “it”, so that is what is used. If you need or want to use a different anaphor, use `a?if`. The most common use of `aif` is for when you want to do some additional computation with some time-consuming calculation, but only if it returned successfully.

Syntax

```
(aif conditional t-action &optional nil-action)
```

Arguments and Values

conditional The boolean conditional to select between the *t-action* and the *nil-action*.

t-action The action to evaluate if the *conditional* evaluate as true.

nil-action The action to evaluate if the *conditional* evaluates as nil.

Examples

```
(aif (big-long-calculation)
     (foo it)
     (format t "The_big-long-calculation_failed!~%"))
```

This is similar to the following, but with less typing:

```
(let ((it (big-long-calculation)))
  (if it
      (foo it)
      (format t "The_big-long-calculation_failed!~%")))
```

Or say you need to get a user name from a database call, which might be slow.

```
(aif (get-user-name)
     (format -t "Hello, ~A!~%" it)
     (format -t "You_aren't_logged_in,_go_away!~%"))
```

2.1.2 The a?if Macro

The *a?if* macro is a variation of *aif* that allows for the specification of the anaphor to use, instead of being restricted to just *it*, the default with *aif*. This is most often useful when you need to nest calls to anaphoric macros.

Syntax

```
(a?if anaphor conditional t-action &optional nil-action)
```

Arguments and Values

anaphor The result of the *conditional* will be stored in the variable specified as the anaphor.

conditional The boolean conditional to select between the *t-action* and the *nil-action*.

t-action The action to evaluate if the *conditional* evaluate as true.

nil-action The action to evaluate if the *conditional* evaluates as nil.

Examples

```
(a?if foo 'outer
  (a?if bar 'inner
    `(:,foo ,bar))) ; Returns '(outer inner)
```

2.1.3 The aand Macro

The `aand` macro is an anaphoric variation of the built-in `and`. This is based on [1, p. 191]. It works in a similar manner to `aif`, defining `it` as the current argument for use in the next argument, reassigning `it` with each argument.

Syntax

```
(aand &rest arguments)
```

Examples

```
(aand 2          ; Sets 'it' to 2.
  (* 3 it)      ; Sets 'it' to 6.
  (* 4 it))    ; Returns 24.
```

2.1.4 The a?and Macro

The `a?and` macro is a variant of `aand` that allows for the specification of the anaphor to use, instead of being restricted to just `it`, the default with `aand`. This is most often useful when you need to nest calls to anaphoric macros.

Examples

```
(a?and foo 12 (* 2 foo) (* 3 foo)) ; Returns 72.

(a?and foo 1 2 3 'outer
  (a?and bar 4 5 6 'inner `(:,foo ,bar))) ; Returns '(outer inner)
```

2.1.5 The `alambda` Macro

The `alambda` macro is an anaphoric variant of the built-in `lambda`. This is based on [1, p. 193]. It works in a similar manner to `aif` and `aand`, except it defines `self` instead of `it` as the default anaphor. This is useful so that you can write recursive lambdas.

```
(funcall (alambda (x) ; Simple recursive factorial example.
  (if (<= x 0)
    1
    (* x (self (1- x)))))
10))) ; Calculates 10!, inefficently.
```

2.1.6 The `a?lambda` Macro

The `a?lambda` macro is a variant of `alambda` that allows you to specify the anaphor to use, instead of just the default of `it`.

```
(funcall (a?lambda ! (x) ; Simple recursive factorial example.
  (if (<= x 0)
    1
    (* x (! (1- x)))))
10))) ; Calculates 10!, inefficently.
```

2.1.7 The `ablock` Macro

The `ablock` macro is an anaphoric variant of the built-in `block`. This is based on [1, p. 193]. It works in a similar manner to `aand`, defining the anaphor `it` for each argument to the block.

Examples

```
(let (w x y z)
  (ablock b
    (setf w 7)
    (setf x (* 2 it)) ; Twice w, 14.
    (setf y (* 3 it)) ; Thrice x, 42.
    (return-from b)   ; Leave the block.
    (setf z 123))     ; Never happens.
  (list w x y z))     ; Returns '(7 14 42 nil)
```

2.1.8 The `a?block` Macro

The `a?block` macro is an anaphoric variant of `ablock` that allows you to specify the anaphor to use, instead of just the default of `it`.

Examples

```
(let (w x y z)
  (a?block b foo
    (setf w 7)
    (setf x (* 2 foo)) ; Twice w, 14.
    (setf y (* 3 foo)) ; Thrice x, 42.
    (return-from b)    ; Leave the block.
    (setf z 123))      ; Never happens.
  (list w x y z))      ; Returns '(7 14 42 nil)
```

2.1.9 The acond Macro

The `acond` macro is an anaphoric variant of the built-in `cond`. This is based on [1, p. 191]. It works in a similar manner to `aand`, defining the anaphor `it` for each argument to the conditional.

Examples

```
(let (a b (c 3))
  (acond (a it)          ; No.
        (b it)          ; No.
        (c (* 4 it)))) ; Yes, returns 12 = 4*3, the value of c.
```

2.1.10 The a?cond Macro

The `a?cond` macro is an anaphoric variant of `acond` that allows you to specify the anaphor to use, instead of just the default of `it`.

Examples

```
(let (a b (c 3))
  (a?cond foo
    (a foo)          ; No.
    (b foo)          ; No.
    (c (* 4 foo)))) ; Yes, returns 12 = 4*3, the value of c.
```

2.1.11 The awhen Macro

The `awhen` macro is an anaphoric variant of `when` built-in. This is based on [1, p. 191]. It works in a similar manner to `aif`, defining `it` as the default anaphor. This is useful when the conditional is the result of a complicated computation, so you don't have to compute it twice or wrap the computation in a `let` block yourself.

Syntax

```
(awhen conditional &body body)
```

Examples

```
(awhen (get-user-name)
  (do-something-with-name it)
  (do-more-stuff)
  (format -t "Hello, ~A!~%" it))
```

2.1.12 The a?when Macro

The `a?when` macro is similar to the `awhen`, except that it allows you to specify the anaphor to use, instead of just the default of `it`.

Syntax

```
(a?when conditional &body body)
```

Examples

```
(a?when user (get-user-name)
  (do-something-with-name user)
  (do-more-stuff)
  (format -t "Hello, ~A!~%" user))
```

2.1.13 The awhile Macro

The `awhile` macro is an anaphoric variant of `while`. This is based on [1, p. 191]. This is useful if you need to consume input repeatedly for all input.

Syntax

```
(awhile expression &body body)
```

Examples

```
(awhile (get-input)
  (do-something it)) ; Operate on input for all input.
```

2.1.14 The a?while Macro

The `a?while` macro is a variant of `awhile` that allows you to specify the anaphor to use, instead of just the default `it`.

Syntax

```
(awhile anaphor expression &body body)
```

Examples

```
(awhile input (get-input)
  (do-something input)) ; Operate on input for all input.
```

2.1.15 The deletef Macro

The `deletef` macro deletes `item` from `sequence` in-place.

Syntax

```
(deletef item sequence &rest rest)
```

Examples

```
(let ((men '(good bad ugly)))
  (deletef 'bad men)
  (deletef 'ugly men)
  men) ; Only the good is left.
```

2.1.16 The do-while Macro

The `do-while` macro operates like a `do {BODY} while (CONDITIONAL)` in the C programming language.

Syntax

```
(do-while conditional &body body)
```

Examples

```
(let ((t-minus 10))
  (do-while (<= 0 t-minus)
    (format t "~A_..." t-minus)
    (decf t-minus)))
(format t "Liftoff!~%")
```

2.1.17 The do-until Macro

The `do-until` macro operates like a `do {body} while (! conditional)` in the C programming language.

Syntax

```
(do-until conditional &body body)
```

Examples

```
(let ((t-minus 10))
  (do-until (< t-minus 0)
    (format t "~A_..." t-minus)
    (decf t-minus)))
(format t "Liftoff!~%")
```

2.1.18 The fop Macro

`fop` is like the `opf` macro, but as a post-assignment variant. The difference is similar to the difference between `x++` and `++x` in the C Programming Language, with `opf` being like `++x` and `fop` being like `x++`.

Syntax

```
(fop operator variable &rest arguments)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 10))
  (while (<= 0 x)
    (format t "~A_..." (fop #'- x 1))))
(format t "Liftoff!~%")
```

2.1.19 The for Macro

A `for` macro, much like the `for` in the C programming language.

Syntax

```
(for initial conditional step-action &body body)
```

Examples

```
(for ((i 0))
  (< i 10)
  (incf i)
  (format t \ "~%~A\"_i))
```

2.1.20 The forever Macro

The `forever` macro is just a way to say `(while t ...)` with a bit of added expressiveness and explicitness.

Examples

```
(forever (let ((in (read)))
  (if (eq in 'quit))
      (format t "I_can't_let_you_do_that,_Dave.")
      (format t "You_entered_~A" in))))
```

2.1.21 The multicond Macro

The `multicond` macro is much like `cond`, but where multiple clauses may be evaluated.

Examples

```
(let ((x 12))
  (multicond ((= x 12) ; This will evaluate.
              (format t "X_is_12!_My_favorite_number!~%"))
              (< x 100) ; This will evaluate also.
              (format t "X_is_small.~%"))
              (< x 0) ; But this one won't.
              (format t "X_is_negative.~%")))))
```

2.1.22 The opf Macro

The `opf` macro is a generic operate-and-store, along the lines of `incf` and `decf`, but allowing for any operation.

Syntax

```
(opf operator variable &rest arguments)
```

Examples

```

;;; Prints 1 ... 2 ... 4 ... 8 ... ... ... 65535 ... that's it!
(let ((x 1))
  (while (<= x (expt 2 16))
    (format t "~A_" x)
    (opf #'* x 2)))
(format t "_that's_it!~%")

```

2.1.23 The swap Macro

This is a simple swap macro. The values of the first and second form are swapped with each other.

Syntax

```
(swap x y)
```

Examples

```

(let ((first "the_first")
      (last "the_last"))
  (swap first last)
  `(',first ,last)) ; Returns '("the last" "the first")

```

2.1.24 The swap-unless Macro

This macro calls `swap` unless the predicate evaluates to true.

Syntax

```
(swap-unless predicate x y)
```

Examples

```

;;; make smaller and larger in the correct order.
(let ((smaller 12)
      (larger 266))
  (swap-unless #'<= smaller larger))

```

2.1.25 The swap-when Macro

This macro calls `swap` when the predicate evaluates to true.

Syntax

```
(swap-when predicate x y)
```

Examples

```
;;; make smaller and larger in the correct order.  
(let ((smaller 12)  
      (larger 6))  
  (swap-when #'> smaller larger))
```

2.1.26 The until Macro

The `until` macro is similar to the `while` loop in C, but with a negated conditional.

Syntax

```
(until conditional &body body)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 10))  
  (until (< x 0)  
    (format t "~A..._ " x)  
    (decf x))  
  (format t "Liftoff!~%"))
```

2.1.27 The while Macro

This `while` macro is similar to the `while` loop in C.

Syntax

```
(while conditional &body body)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 10))  
  (while (<= 0 x)  
    (format t "~A..._ " x)  
    (decf x))  
  (format t "Liftoff!~%"))
```

2.2 Functions

2.2.1 The compose Function

The `compose` function composes a single function from a list of several functions such that the new function is equivalent to calling the functions in succession. This is based upon a `compose` function in [2], which is based upon the `compose` function from Dylan.

Syntax

```
(compose &rest functions)
```

Examples

We want to calculate:

$$\sin(\cos(\tan(\pi))) \approx 0.841,470,984,807,896,5$$

```
(funcall (compose #'sin #'cos #'tan) pi)
(sin (cos (tan pi))) ; This is the same.
```

2.2.2 The conjoin Function

The `conjoin` function takes in one or more predicates, and returns a predicate that returns true whenever all of the predicates return true. This is from [2] and is based upon the `conjoin` function from Dylan.

Syntax

```
(conjoin predicate &rest predicates)
```

Examples

```
;;; Returns '(6 12 18 24 30 36 42 48 54 60 66 72 78 84 90 96).
(remove-if-not #'identity
  (flet ((mod-2? (i) (zerop (mod i 2)))
        (mod-3? (i) (zerop (mod i 3))))
    (loop for i from 1 to 100 collect
      (when (funcall (conjoin #'mod-2? #'mod-3?) i)
        i))))
```


2.2.3 The curry Function

The `curry` function takes in a function and some of its arguments, and returns a function that expects the rest of the required arguments. This is from [2] and is based upon the `curry` function from Dylan.

Syntax

```
(curry function &rest arguments)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 100)
      (f (curry #' + x)))
  (loop for i from 1 to 10 collect
        (funcall f i))) ; Returns '(101 102 103 ... 110)
```

2.2.4 The disjoin Function

The `disjoin` function takes in one or more predicates, and returns a predicate that returns true whenever any of the predicates return true. This is from [2] and is based upon the `disjoin` function from Dylan.

Syntax

```
(disjoin predicate &rest predicates)
```

Examples

```
;;; Returns ' (#\1 #\2 #\3 #\a #\b #\c NIL      NIL)
(let ((chars ' (#\1 #\2 #\3 #\a #\b #\c #\Space #\Newline)))
  (mapcar (lambda (c)
            (when (funcall (disjoin #'alpha-char-p #'digit-char-p)
                           c)
              c))
          chars))
```

2.2.5 The function-alias Function

The `function-alias` function produces one or more aliases (alternate names) for a function.

Syntax

```
(function-alias function &rest aliases)
```

Examples

```
(function-alias 'that-guy-doesnt-know-when-to-stop-typing 'shorter)
```

2.2.6 The operator-to-function Function

The `operator-to-function` function takes in any symbol and makes an evaluable function out of it. The principle purpose for this is so that we can treat macros and other non-function things like a function, for using them with `mapcar` or similar.

Known Issues

[Issue #8]

Syntax

```
(operator-to-function operator)
```

Examples

```
;;; In case you don't like (setf a 1 b 2 c 3).
(mapcar (operator-to-function 'setf)
        '(a b c)
        '(1 2 3))
```

2.2.7 The rcompose Function

The `rcompose` function is a reversed variant of the `compose` function.

Syntax

```
(compose &rest functions)
```

Examples

We want to calculate:

$$\tan(\cos(\sin(\pi))) \approx 1.557,407,724,654,902,3$$

```
(funcall (rcompose #'sin #'cos #'tan) pi)
(tan (cos (sin pi))) ; This is the same.
```

2.2.8 The rcurry Function

This function takes in a function and some of its ending arguments, and returns a function that expects the rest of the required arguments. This is from [2] and is based upon the `rcurry` function from Dylan.

Syntax

```
(rcurry function &rest arguments)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 100)
      (f (rcurry #'- x)))
  (loop for i from 1 to 10 collect
        (funcall f i))) ; Returns '(-99 -98 -97 ... -90)
```

2.2.9 The unimplemented Function

This is a convenience function that merely raises an error. It is for code that is yet to be written.

Syntax

```
(unimplemented)
```

Examples

```
(defun turing-test-solver ()
  (unimplemented)) ; TODO: figure out how to program this.
```

2.3 Generics

2.3.1 The duplicate Generic

The `duplicate` generic is to provide a deep copy facility for any of your objects. If you define a class and want a deep copy facility for it, implement a version of `duplicate` that is correct for it. This library provides versions of `duplicate` for most built-in classes already.

Chapter 3

The sigma/hash Package

3.1 Macros

3.1.1 The sethash Macro

The `sethash` macro is shortcut for `setf gethash`.

Syntax

```
(set-partition key hash-table value)
```

Arguments and Values

key The key to add to in the hash table.

hash-table The hash table we are modifying.

value The value to set the hash table key to.

Returns

The new *value* for key.

3.1.2 The set-partition Macro

The `set-partition` macro is a variant of `sethash` that assumes the hash entries are all sequences, allowing for multiple results per key. When you call `gethash` on the hashmap you will get back a sequence of all the entries for that key.

Syntax

```
(set-partition key hash-table value)
```

Arguments and Values

key The key to add to in the hash table.

hash-table The partition, a hash table, we are modifying.

value The value to add to the hash table key.

Returns

The new set of values for key, a sequence containing your newly added *value* and any previously added values.

3.2 Functions

3.2.1 The populate-hash-table Function

The `populate-hash-table` function makes initial construction of hash tables a lot easier, just taking in key/value pairs as the arguments to the function, and returning a newly-constructed hash table.

Examples

```
(populate-hash-table 'name "Valentinus"
                     'likes ' (birds roses)
                     'dislikes ' (beheadings epilepsy "false_idols")
                     'died 269)
```

3.2.2 The inchash Function

The `inchash` function will increment the value in *key* of the *hash*, initializing it to 1 if it isn't currently defined.

3.2.3 The dechash Function

The `dechash` function will decrement the value in *key* of the *hash*, initializing it to -1 if it isn't currently defined.

3.2.4 The gethash-in Function

The `gethash-in` function works like `gethash`, but allows for multiple keys to be specified at once, to work with nested hash tables.

Syntax

```
(gethash-in keys hash-table &optional default)
```

Arguments and Values

keys A list of objects.

hash-table A hash table.

default An object. The default is nil.

Returns

value An object.

present? A generalized boolean.

Examples

```
(let ((h (make-hash-table)))
  (sethash 'a h 12)
  (gethash-in '(a) h)) ; Returns 12

(let ((h (make-hash-table))
      (i (make-hash-table)))
  (sethash 'b i 123)
  (sethash 'a h i)
  (gethash-in '(a b) h 123)) ; Returns 123
```

3.2.5 The make-partition Function

The `make-partition` function is a variant of `make-hash-table` that assumes you're going to use the hash table for partitions with multiple entries per key, not a one-to-one hashmap.

Syntax

```
(make-partition)
```

3.2.6 The populate-partition Function

The `populate-partition` function make initial construction of a partition a lot easier, just taking in key/value pairs as the arguments to the function, where there can be multiple entries for any key, and returning a newly-constructed partition.

Syntax

```
(populate-partition &rest pairs)
```

Examples

```
(populate-partition 'a ' (1 2 3)
                   'a 4
                   'a ' (5 6 7)
                   'b 8
                   'c 9
                   'c 10
                   'd 11
                   'a 147)
```


Chapter 4

The sigma/numeric Package

4.1 Macros

4.1.1 The `+f` Macro

The `+f` macro is an alias for `incf`.

4.1.2 The `-f` Macro

The `-f` macro is an alias for `decf`.

4.1.3 The `*f` Macro

The `*f` macro is an alias for `multf`.

4.1.4 The `/f` Macro

The `/f` macro is an alias for `divf`.

4.1.5 The `divf` Macro

The `divf` macro is divide-and-store, along the lines of `incf` and `decf`, but with division instead. This is similar to `x /= something` in the C programming language.

Syntax

`(divf variable &rest arguments)`

Examples

```
;;; Prints 65536 ... 8 ... 4 ... 2 ... 1 ... 0 ... that's it!
(let ((x (expt 2 16)))
  (while (<= 0 x)
    (format t "~A~..." x)
    (divf x 2)))
(format t "~that's it!~%")
```

4.1.6 The f+ Macro

The `f+` macro is similar to `incf` or `+f`, but it is a post-increment instead of a pre-increment. That is, `f+` works like `x++` in C but `incf` and `+f` work like `++x` in C.

Syntax

```
(f+ variable &rest addends)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 12))
  (list x (f+ x) x)) ; Returns '(12 12 13).
```

4.1.7 The f- Macro

The `f-` macro is similar to `decf` or `-f`, but it is a post-decrement instead of a pre-decrement. That is, `f-` works like `x--` in C but `decf` and `-f` work like `--x` in C.

Syntax

```
(f- variable &rest subtrahends)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 12))
  (list x (f- x) x)) ; Returns '(12 12 11).
```

4.1.8 The f* Macro

The `f*` macro is similar to `multf` or `*f`, but it is a post-multiply instead of a pre-multiply. That is, `f*` works like `x++` in C (just for multiplication instead of addition) but `multf` and `*f` work like `++x` in C (again, just for multiplication instead of addition.)

Syntax

```
(f* variable &rest multiplicands)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 12))
  (list x (f* x 2) x)) ; Returns '(12 12 24).
```

4.1.9 The f/ Macro

The `f/` macro is similar to `divf` or `/f`, but it is a post-divide instead of a pre-divide. That is, `f/` works like `x++` in C (just for division instead of addition) but `divf` and `/f` work like `++x` in C (again, just for division instead of addition.)

Syntax

```
(f/ variable &rest divisors)
```

Examples

```
(let ((x 12))
  (list x (f/ x 2) x)) ; Returns '(12 12 6).
```

4.1.10 The multf Macro

The `divf` macro is multiply-and-store, along the lines of `incf` and `decf`, but with multiplication instead. This is similar to `x *= something` in the C programming language.

Syntax

```
(multf variable &rest arguments)
```

Examples

```
;;; Prints 1 ... 2 ... 4 ... 8 ... ... 65535 ... that's it!
(let ((x 1))
  (while (<= x (expt 2 16))
    (format t "~A~..." x)
    (multf x 2))
  (format t "~that's it!~%"))
```

4.2 Functions

4.2.1 The bit? Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.2 The choose Function

The *choose* function computes the binomial coefficient for n and k , typically spoken as n choose k , and usually written mathematically as $\binom{n}{k}$.

4.2.3 The factorial Function

The *factorial* function computes $n!$ for positive integers. NB, this isn't intelligent, and uses a loop instead of better approaches.

4.2.4 The fractional-part Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.5 The fractional-value Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.6 The integer-range Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.7 The nonnegative? Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.8 The nonnegative-integer? Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.9 The positive-integer? Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.10 The product Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.11 The `sum` Function

...TO DO ...

4.2.12 The `unsigned-integer?` Function

...TO DO ...

4.3 Types

4.3.1 The `nonnegative-float` Type

...TO DO ...

4.3.2 The `nonnegative-integer` Type

...TO DO ...

4.3.3 The `positive-float` Type

...TO DO ...

4.3.4 The `positive-integer` Type

...TO DO ...

Chapter 5

The sigma/os Package

5.1 Functions

5.1.1 The perl Function

...TO DO ...

5.1.2 The python Function

...TO DO ...

5.1.3 The read-file Function

...TO DO ...

5.1.4 The read-lines Function

...TO DO ...

5.1.5 The ruby Function

...TO DO ...

5.2 Parameters

5.2.1 The *perl-path* Parameter

...TO DO ...

5.2.2 The **python-path Parameter**

...TO DO ...

5.2.3 The **ruby-path Parameter**

...TO DO ...

Chapter 6

The sigma/probability Package

6.1 Macros

6.1.1 The decaying-probability? Macro

...TO DO ...

6.2 Functions

6.2.1 The probability? Function

...TO DO ...

6.3 Types

6.3.1 The probability Type

...TO DO ...

Chapter 7

The sigma/random Package

7.1 Macros

7.1.1 The nshuffle Macro

...TO DO ...

7.2 Functions

7.2.1 The gauss Function

...TO DO ...

7.2.2 The random-argument Function

...TO DO ...

7.2.3 The coin-toss Function

...TO DO ...

7.2.4 The random-in-range Function

...TO DO ...

7.2.5 The random-in-ranges Function

...TO DO ...

7.2.6 The random-range Function

...TO DO ...

7.2.7 The randomize-array Function

...TO DO ...

7.2.8 The random-array Function

...TO DO ...

7.3 Generics**7.3.1 The random-element Generic**

...TO DO ...

7.3.2 The shuffle Generic

...TO DO ...

Chapter 8

The sigma/sequence Package

8.1 Macros

8.1.1 The arefable? Macro

...TO DO ...

8.1.2 The nconcf Macro

...TO DO ...

8.1.3 The nthable? Macro

...TO DO ...

8.1.4 The set-nthcdr Macro

...TO DO ...

8.2 Functions

8.2.1 The array-values Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.2 The nth-from-end Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.3 The sequence? Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.4 The empty-sequence? Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.5 The join-symbol-to-all-following Function

This function takes a symbol and a list, and for every occurrence of the symbol in the list, it joins it to the item following it. For example:

Syntax

```
(join-symbol-to-all-following symbol list)
```

Examples

```
(join-symbol-to-all-following :# '(:# 10 :# 20 :# 30))  
;; Returns '(:#10 :#20 :#30)
```

Affected By

```
*print-escape*, *print-radix*, *print-base*, *print-circle*,  
*print-pretty*, *print-level*, *print-length*, *print-case*,  
*print-gensym*, *print-array*.
```

8.2.6 The join-symbol-to-all-preceding Function

This function takes a symbol and a list, and for every occurrence of the symbol in the list, it joins it to the item preceding it. For example:

Syntax

```
(join-symbol-to-all-preceding symbol list)
```

Examples

```
(join-symbol-to-all-preceding :% '(10 :% 20 :% 30 :%))  
;; Returns '(:10% :20% :30%)
```

Affected By

`*print-escape*`, `*print-radix*`, `*print-base*`, `*print-circle*`,
`*print-pretty*`, `*print-level*`, `*print-length*`, `*print-case*`,
`*print-gensym*`, `*print-array*`.

8.2.7 The list-to-vector Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.8 The max* Function

The `max*` function is a shortcut for `max`. It takes in one or more lists and finds the maximum value within all of them. This is so you don't have to manually use `apply` and `concatenate`.

Syntax

```
(min &rest lists)
```

Examples

```
(max* '(1 2 3 100 4 5)) ; Returns 100  
(max* '(1 2 3 4)  
      '(5 6 99 7)  
      '(8 9 10)) ; Returns 99
```

8.2.9 The min* Function

The `min*` function is a shortcut for `min`. It takes in one or more lists and finds the maximum value within all of them. This is so you don't have to manually use `apply` and `concatenate`.

Syntax

```
(min &rest lists)
```

Examples

```
(min* '(1 2 3 -100 4 5)) ; Returns -100  
(min* '(1 2 3 4)  
      '(5 6 -99 7)  
      '(8 9 10)) ; Returns -99
```

8.2.10 The set-equal Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.11 The simple-vector-to-list Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.12 The sort-order Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.13 The the-last Function

...TO DO ...

8.2.14 The vector-to-list Function

...TO DO ...

8.3 Generics**8.3.1 The best Generic**

...TO DO ...

8.3.2 The minimum Generic

...TO DO ...

8.3.3 The minimum? Generic

...TO DO ...

8.3.4 The maximum Generic

...TO DO ...

8.3.5 The maximum? Generic

...TO DO ...

8.3.6 The sort-on Generic

...TO DO ...

8.3.7 The slice Generic

...TO DO ...

8.3.8 The split Generic

...TO DO ...

8.3.9 The worst Generic

...TO DO ...

Chapter 9

The `sigma/string` Package

The `String` package contains useful tools for working with strings.

9.1 Functions

9.1.1 The `character-range` Function

The `character-range` function returns a list of characters from the *start* to the *end* character. Note that this is returning a list, not a string.

Syntax

```
(character-range start end)  $\Rightarrow$  ' (start ... end)
```

Arguments and Values

start The character to start the range with, inclusive.

end The character to end the range with, inclusive.

Examples

```
(character-range #\a #\e)  $\Rightarrow$  ' (#\a #\b #\c #\d #\e)  
(character-range #\e #\a)  $\Rightarrow$  ' (#\a #\b #\c #\d #\e)
```

9.1.2 The character-ranges Function

The `character-ranges` function is a convenience wrapper for `character-range` function, concatenating several calls and making the resultant list contain only unique instances.

Syntax

```
(character-ranges start1 end1 ... ⇒ ' (character1 ...)
```

Arguments and Values

start_n The character to start the *n*th range with, inclusive.

end_n The character to end the *n*th range with, inclusive.

Examples

```
(character-ranges #\a #\c #\x #\z) ⇒ ' (#\a #\b #\c #\x #\y  
#\z)
```

```
(character-ranges #\a #\c #\a #\c) ⇒ ' (#\a #\b #\c)
```

9.1.3 The escape-tildes Function

...TO DO ...

9.1.4 The replace-char Function

...TO DO ...

9.1.5 The strcat Function

...TO DO ...

9.1.6 The strmult Function

...TO DO ...

9.1.7 The string-join Function

...TO DO ...

9.1.8 The stringify Function

...TO DO ...

9.1.9 The to-string Function

...TO DO ...

9.2 Methods

9.2.1 The split Methods

...TO DO ...

Chapter 10

The time-series Package

10.1 Macros

10.1.1 The snap-index Macro

...TO DO ...

10.2 Functions

10.2.1 The array-raster-line Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.2 The distance Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.3 The norm Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.4 The raster-line Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.5 The similar-points? Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.6 The `time-series?` Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.7 The `time-multiseries?` Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.8 The `tmsref` Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.9 The `tms-dimensions` Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.10 The `tms-raster-line` Function

...TO DO ...

10.2.11 The `tms-values` Function

...TO DO ...

10.3 Types**10.3.1 The `time-multiseries` Type**

...TO DO ...

Chapter 11

The truth Package

11.1 Functions

11.1.1 The `[?]` Function

...TO DO ...

11.1.2 The `toggle` Function

...TO DO ...

11.2 Generics

11.2.1 The `?` Generic

...TO DO ...

Chapter 12

The sigma Package

12.1 Variables

12.1.1 The `*sigma-packages*` Variable

...TO DO ...

12.2 Functions

12.2.1 The `use-all-sigma` Function

...TO DO ...

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